

StarShot Prototype

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1. Game Overview

In the distant future pirate crews sail the solar winds in Sunjammers, roaming between cryptic treasure worlds. They scrap for ancient weapons and dogfight in the void. But only one can earn the title of **Bosa Sennen**, the most feared pirate in the system.

StarShot is a competitive tactical space combat game for 2–4 players. Each round, players secretly prepare three Action stacks for their ship, then reveal and execute those Actions to maneuver their ships, attack opponents, and collect treasure.

The game is played over six rounds, or until only one ship remains. After round six, if more than one player is still alive, the player with the most Victory Points (VP) wins. Players may play on teams, with each player piloting their own ship and sharing common Victory Points with their team.

2. Components

Common game pieces:

- 1 Hex-based Space board approximately 12 hexes in radius
- 10 Bauble number tokens
- 1 Round and Bauble Track
- 2 Six-sided dice
- 1 Twelve-sided die
- 1 Desperation card deck
- 1 One-Minute hourglass
- 30 One Victory Point tokens
- 15 Five Victory Point tokens
- 60 Ship damage/shield charge markers

Per-player game pieces:

- 1 Starship token
- 1 Orders deck
- 1 Set of 3 Sealed Orders cards in their color
- 1 Starship hex layout board with Deck, Discard, Overheat, and Victory Point areas

3. Setup

1. Place the Space board in reach of all players, and place each player's ship token in its matching color starting tile, facing the center of the board.
2. Shuffle the Bauble Round tokens and place them randomly on the 10 red Baubles scattered around the Space board, number side up. Do not place a Round token on The Fang, which is the central Bauble.
3. Set the Round and Bauble track to Round 1 and place it in view of all players.
4. Set the Victory Point tokens in reach of all players.
5. Shuffle the Desperation deck, and place it next to the Space board with the Desperately Reshuffle card on the bottom.

6. Distribute to each player the color-matched set of 3 Sealed Orders cards and Starship board matching their token.
7. Distribute an Orders deck to each player. It should consist of 7 Move cards and 3 Attack cards. Note the Orders deck does not have the distinctive Desperation markings on its cards.
8. Choose the starting player by rolling dice. The player with the highest roll is the starting player.

4.Round Structure

StarShot is played over a series of rounds. Each round follows the same sequence:

1. Give Orders
2. Action 1
3. Action 2
4. Action 3
5. Award Baubles
6. Cleanup

Give Orders

Each player draws 5 cards from their deck, and secretly prepares three Action stacks - **Action 1**, **Action 2**, and **Action 3**. These will be executed in sequence, with each player performing each Action step before advancing to the next. Note: Once a player's ship loses its shields, the player's draw increases to 6 cards.

Desperate Inspiration (Variant): When the inner circle of hexes surrounding a player's bridge is breached, that player's draw increases to 7 cards.

The first player to finish choosing orders and Sealing them turns starts the 1 minute hourglass. At the end of that 1 additional minute, the Give Orders step ends, and any unsealed Actions are left empty.

Empty Deck

If a player exhausts their deck in their attempt to draw cards, that player shuffles their discard pile to create a new deck. Then the player puts their Overheat pile into their Discard pile. Then they draw the remaining necessary cards.

To create each of the three Action stacks:

1. Choose up to two Command cards from your deck with the same type (Move or Attack).
2. The Face (Front or Back) and Orientation (Up or Down) are important and cannot be changed after Orders are issued.
3. Cover the stack with the matching **Sealed** card corresponding to the Action number, placing the **Sealed** card either "Sealed" face up or "Overdrive" face up.

After all three Action stacks have been prepared, discard unused Command cards to your Discard Pile. When every player has finished giving orders and Sealed their Action stacks, the round begins.

Resolve Actions

The three Action stacks are resolved one at a time, beginning with **Action 1** and ending with **Action 3**.

For each Action:

1. Every player reveals their matching Action stack.
2. All Movement cards are resolved simultaneously. Moves execute in their stacked order. Overdrive moves happen immediately after normal moves.
3. The Combat stage takes place, beginning with the starting player and continuing clockwise. If a player has an Overdrive attack, they perform it immediately after their normal attack, before the next player attacks.
4. Once Movement and Combat have finished, replace the Sealed card atop the actions that were executed and rotate it 90 degrees to indicate the Action is done. It will remain in the play area until the end of the round.

Award Baubles

If a player's ship is in a red Bauble circle on the Space board corresponding to the current round or within The Fang's circle in the center, award them the appropriate Victory Points and a Desperation card.

Cleanup

Complete the following steps in order:

1. Resolve any effects that occur during Cleanup.
2. For each of the Sealed card's orders
 - a. Normally Sealed Command cards go to the player's Discard pile. This includes Desperation cards played on their Basic face.
 - b. Overdriven Command cards go to the player's Overheat pile.
 - c. Desperation cards played with their Desperate face return to the bottom of the common Desperation deck.
 - d. If an order was executed with Overdrive, the Sealed/Overdrive card itself is placed on top of the player's deck.
3. Advance the Round Tracker.
4. Rotate the Starting Player designation clockwise.

Then begin the next round.

5. Ending the Game

At the completion of a Round, if only one player's ship is not destroyed, that player wins the game. If all ships are destroyed, the game is a tie.

Otherwise, at the completion of Round 6 the game ends, and the player with the most Victory Points wins. In case of a tie, the player with the most destroyed ship components wins. If it is still a tie, talk like a pirate for the next game.

Variant Rule: The Void Beckons

If a player's ship is destroyed before round 6, they may rejoin the game at the beginning of the next round with no VP and their original deck and intact ship, as though they had just begun the game. Alternatively, they may choose to remain eliminated and keep their VP. In this variant, the winner is determined solely by Victory Points, and not by last-ship-standing.

6. Cards

There are two types of cards: Command Cards and Sealed Cards.

Command Cards

Command cards represent the activities of the captain and the crew, as they move about the system and attack their foes. Command cards are combined to form Orders and then Sealed as the activities for an Action.

Orders and Card Types

An Order is composed of 1 or 2 Command Cards of the same type: Attack or Move.

Face and Orientation matter. Some cards have a face that is Attack in one orientation and Move in the other.

A card's type and function for the purposes of an Order is the face that is on top and the orientation that is upright. The text oriented upright is followed, while any upside down text is ignored.

Move Cards and Orders

Move cards are green. The Move cards in a Move order are executed in the order they were Sealed, first the top card and then the second card.

Move cards can have the following keywords.

1. Move X: Move your ship X hexes in the direction it is currently facing.
2. Turn {Right | Left}: Rotate your ship exactly one hex face in the direction indicated.

If a card has multiple directives, follow them in the order written.

<Figure: a Move Order with a Move and a Turn on it.>

Attack Cards and Orders

Attack cards are red. The Attack cards in an Attack order combine to form a Volley. The Volley may be Targeted, have an Aim bonus, and/or have a Damage bonus.

- Targeted: A Targeted Attack card has 4 arrows, one on each face and orientation in the colors of the 4 player ships. If a card in the Volley is Targeted, the **Volley** is targeted. If two cards are Targeted, they must have the same target.
 - If the Volley is Targeted, the attack is made against the ship designated by the forward facing arrow of the top face.
 - If the Volley is not Targeted, trace a line on the game board directly forward from the player ship, beginning in its own hex. If an enemy ship is exactly on the line, the attack is treated as if it targeted the first ship in that line. If multiple ships share the first occupied hex in the line, the attack targets the one with less total Defense. If they have identical Defense, the attack targets them both. If there are no ships on the line, the attack misses.
- Aim +X: The **Volley** gains a bonus on its Attack Roll equal to the total Aim bonus provided by both cards. The default is +0 Aim bonus.

- **Damage +X:** The Volley gains a damage bonus if it hits equal to the total Damage bonus provided by both cards. The default is 0 bonus damage, in which case the attack would deal 1 damage total.
Note: Even though playing two attack cards separately could allow them each to deal 1 base damage, combining them into an order still only deals 1 base damage unless they have +Damage text.

<Figure: an Attack Order with a damage bonus, and the same as two one-card attack orders.>

Other Keywords

Several keywords occur on both Move and Attack cards, and only in the Desperation Deck.

1. **Defense +X:** Your ship's defense is increased by X until the end of the Action.
2. **Warp to X:** Move your ship to the position designated by the text, but do not change the direction unless directed.
3. **U-Turn:** Rotate your ship 3 hex faces so it is in the exact opposite direction.
4. **Range X:** The card only takes effect within X tiles of the player's ship. Note this may be a range, or a "X+" value, in which case the effect area varies per the designation.
5. **Restore X Components:** Remove the damage marker from up to X tiles of your ship. Undamaged tiles must remain contiguous - you can't restore a floating piece.
6. **Reconfigure X:** Re-arrange X damage markers on your ship, retaining the original number. Undamaged tiles must remain contiguous - you can't leave a floating piece.
7. **Move Right/Left:** When moving a direction besides Forward or Backward, move along the forward Right/Left diagonal.
8. **Overdrive 3, 2X:** This card is played in place of your normal Sealed 3/Overdrive 3 card. When used in this way, it creates 2 copies of the Order, rather than the normal 1 copy of Overdrive. It is then returned to the Desperation deck.

Base Deck Cards

Each player begins with a Base Deck consisting of 10 simple cards:

- 2x Targeted Attack, +1 Aim
- 1x Targeted Attack, +2 Aim
- 3x Move 1/(Turn Right and Move 1 / Turn Left and Move 1)
- 4x Move 2/(Turn Right and Move 2 / Turn Left and Move 2)

Note the Move cards have three possible effects: One face to move straight forward, and the opposite face 2 orientations allowing a turn right or left before movement.

Desperation Deck Cards

Desperation cards represent the heroism of the captain and crew in the stress of battle. While the ship may be operating at reduced functionality, in moments of pressure they can accomplish incredible feats.

Desperation cards are drawn from the Desperation deck and added to the player's deck. While in the player's deck, they behave similar to base deck Command cards, with some exceptions. Desperation cards are marked with the distinctive Desperation corner markings to distinguish them from base deck cards

Drawing a Desperation Card

Desperation cards are gained when specified by other mechanics. When you gain a Desperation card, put it on top of your deck, not into your discard pile. If you reveal the “Shuffle Desperately” card, shuffle the deck desperately and then return the shuffle card to the bottom afterwards.

Basic Face

One side of each Desperation card has standard keywords, such as a two-orientation (Move 2 / Attack Aim +2), or a Targeted Attack. When the basic face of a desperation card is played, it behaves identically to a normal Command card.

Desperate Face

The Desperate face of each Desperation card represents a heroic feat of skill and engineering by the captain and his crew, and it pushes the ship beyond its limits.

The Desperate face is identified by an underlined skill name in the center. When a Desperation card's Desperate face is played, it is returned to the Desperation deck during Cleanup. It does not go into the player's Discard or Overheat pile.

When an order is affected by Overdrive, the effect of the Desperate face does not apply to the copied action, only to the original action.

Dev Note: Possible simplifier/nerft: don't allow Overdriving of Orders which include a Desperate face.

Sealed / Overdrive Cards

Each player has 3 two-sided cards that are not Command cards - these are the Seal cards.

- Sealed 1 / Overdrive 1
- Sealed 2 / Overdrive 2
- Sealed 3 / Overdrive 3

These cards are used to Seal their orders, indicating they are prepared to begin the round. When an Order is Sealed with the “Sealed” side, that Order functions normally.

However, if an order is Sealed with the “Overdrive” side, after the original order executes, the entire order (potentially including two cards) is duplicated as an additional Order immediately after the original.

Note that Desperate faces of Desperation cards are not duplicated by an Overdrive, so a Desperation card will be skipped entirely in the second Action.

<Figure of an Overdriven command with a normal face and a Desperate face.>

7. Combat Stage

In the Action step after all moves have been executed, if there are any Attacks being played, each attacker executes their **Volley** of Attack cards by performing the Attack Roll, and then potentially a Shield Check and Damage Roll. The Starting Player completes these, followed by each other attacker in clockwise order. Each player makes only 1 attack in an Action, targeting the ship designated by the Targeted Attack card(s) in the orders.

Note that Overdrive on a **Volley** creates an entirely new **Volley** Action, which means the potential to trigger all per-**Volley** effects twice. This takes place immediately after their first **Volley**, before the next player attacks.

Determine the Volley

A **Volley** is an attempt to hit the enemy for one or more damage, and is formed when giving Orders. Each Volley has a total Aim bonus and total Damage bonus. Note that an Order with multiple Attack cards, even Targeted Attacks, does not create more than one **Volley** or more than one Attack Roll.

<Example figure of a one-card Volley and a two-card Volley>

Attack Roll

Start by identifying the target of the Attack as described in **Attack Cards and Orders**. Measure the distance in hexes from the attacker to their target starting with the first empty hex adjacent to the attacker and ending on the target's hex. Take that distance and add the total movement executed by the target earlier this Action. If the defender has a Defense bonus, add it to that total. The result is the Final Defense value you need to hit. Then roll 2d6 (2 six-sided dice) and add any Aim bonuses. If the result is equal or greater than the Final Defense, the **Volley** attack is a Hit!

Final Defense = Distance + Target's Movement this Action

Attack Bonus = Granted by cards (default 0)

If Roll 2d6 + Attack Bonus >= Final Defense: Attack Hits

<Figure for Distance + Move = Target Roll>

Shields and Damage

If a ship would be hit by a **Volley**, it can be blocked by Shields. Ships begin with 2 shield charges. If the ship would take damage while shield charges remain, the Shield generator activates, protecting the ship from all incoming damage for the rest of that step (ie. against all attackers' **Volleys**), and expending one shield charge. One Shield generator activation prevents all damage across that entire Action step, regardless of source or amount. Striking an active Shield generates one VP for the attacker regardless of the size of the **Volley**, or whether the player triggered the Shield activation or hit the triggered Shield later in that Action step.

Note that once a player's ship's shields are exhausted, the player draws 6 cards during the Give Orders step.

Unshielded Hits

Once all shield charges are expended, hits damage the ship structure itself. The base damage for every **Volley** is 1, even if two Attack cards are included in the **Volley**. The damage may be increased if one of the Attack cards specifies a Damage +X modifier.

When a player hits an unshielded enemy ship, the attacker gains one Victory Point if at least one component is destroyed, or three if the **Volley** results in total ship destruction. Note that it is possible to score a hit but not strike any components if the ship is sufficiently damaged that the shot passes through it, resulting in no VP being awarded. Destroying multiple components in the same Volley does not grant additional VP's.

The +Damage bonus does not add additional victory points, although it does result in additional damage rolls. An Overdriven Volley can potentially hit again and yield additional VPs, as it is a separate Action.

Gaining Desperation Under Attack

When the hits start coming the defender's ship loses capability but the crew gains that edge of desperation. The first time a ship component is destroyed by a given **Volley**, the defender does the following:

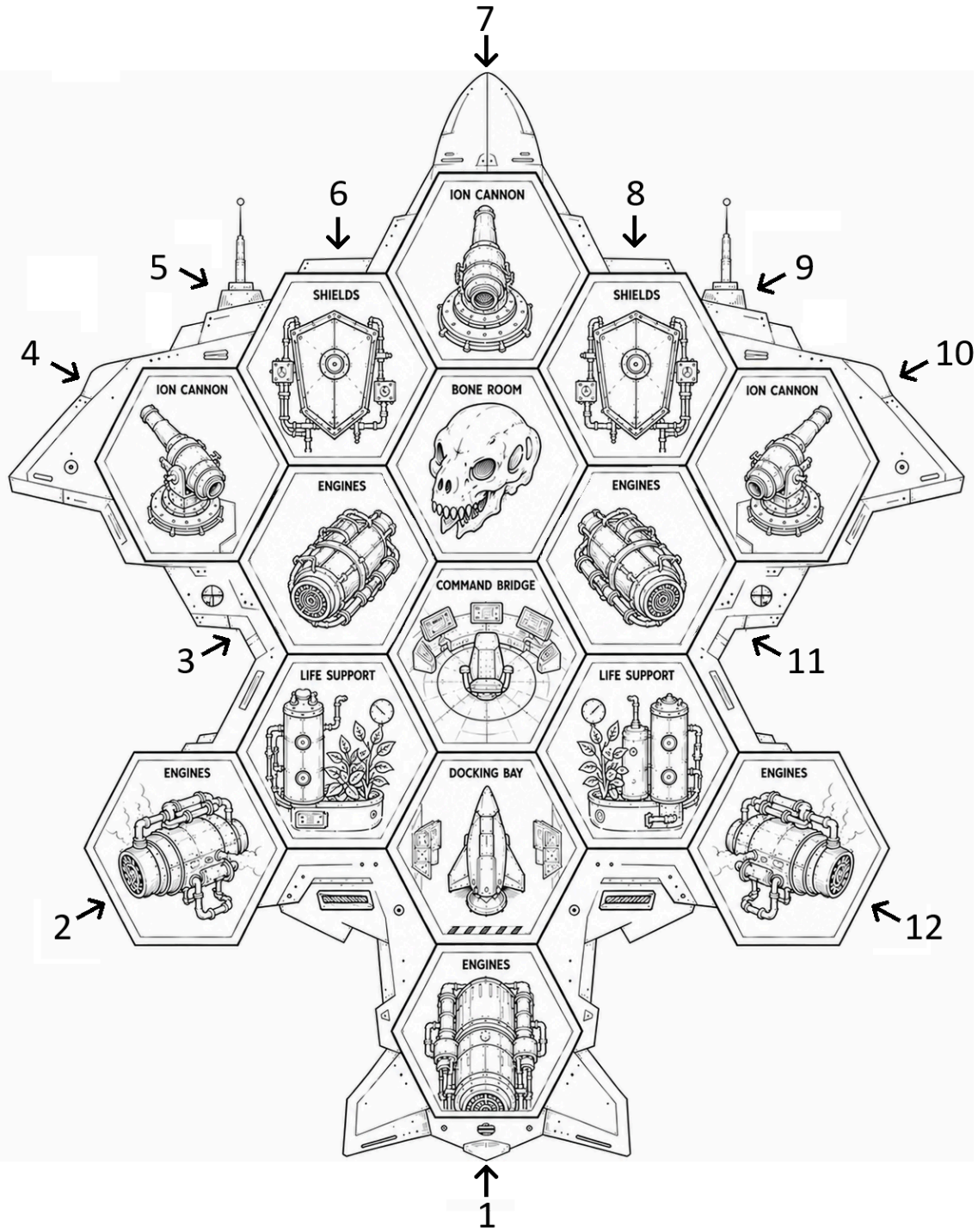
1. Move the top card from their Deck to their Overheat pile
2. Draw the top card of the Desperation deck, placing it on top of their own deck

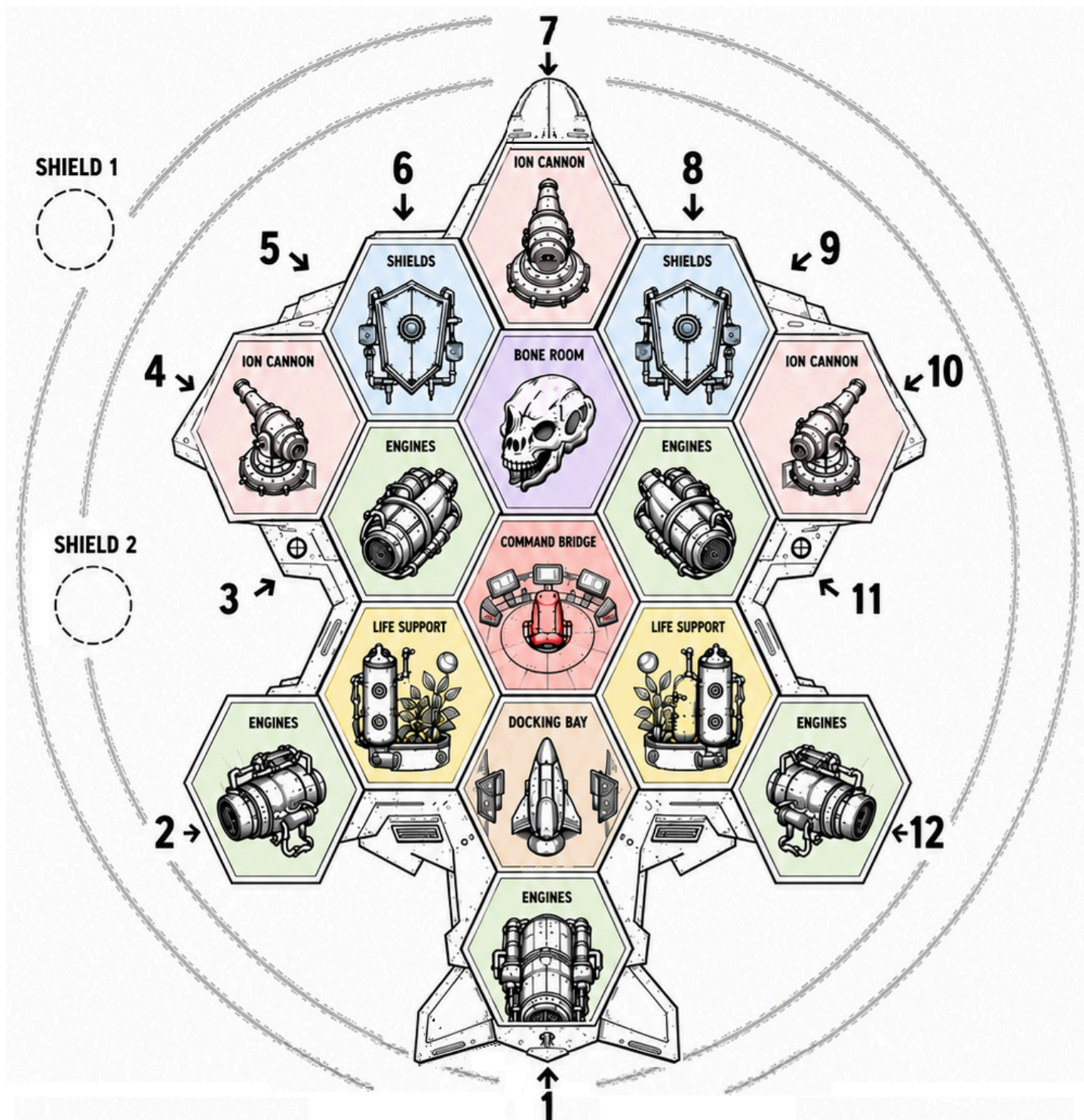
If the player has no cards remaining in their deck when they are hit, they shuffle their Discard pile into their deck first.

Damage Location

For each point of damage within the **Volley**, roll 1d12 to determine the lane where the hit occurs. Once the incoming shot's lane is chosen, it destroys the first component in the lane, passing through tiles where components are already destroyed. Consequently, damage can reach the Bridge after components blocking access are destroyed.

Ship Diagram





**SHIELDS BREACHED
AND TAKING DAMAGE?**



Put top card
from your **DECK**
into **OVERHEAT**.



Place a new
DESPERATION card
on top of your **DECK**.

DECK



DISCARD



OVERHEAT



Ship Destruction

If a ship suffers enough damage, it can be destroyed. Losing any of the following groups is lethal.

1. The Bridge component
2. Both Life Support components

If an attacker eliminates the ship entirely, such as by destroying the Bridge, the attacker gains 3 VP instead of the normal 1 for the **Volley**. Note that any attacks in the current Action ordered by a ship before it was eliminated still take effect - all ships had a chance to fire their weapons before shots began to hit.

8. Baubles

Scattered across the Congregation are Baubles, small worlds veiled in a shield of glimmering energy. But very rarely, the shield dissipates for mere hours, and a timely crew can find ancient treasures. Across the map are 11 baubles, two each randomly numbered 1 through 5 and a final Bauble for round 6 named **The Fang**. At the end of each round, the matching numbered Baubles open, and any crew that is within 1 tile of it may reap the rewards.

During the Award Baubles step, if you are within 1 tile of the Bauble that matches the round number, you gain Victory Points as shown on the Bauble track, and you draw a card from the Desperation deck.

The final Bauble is **The Fang**. Its riches are legendary but deadly. During the Award Baubles step if you are within 1 tile of **The Fang**, gain 1 VP and take 1 damage (roll one time for all ships). Round 6 rewards 6 VP and deals 1 damage.

Bauble Round Point Progression

Round	1	2	3	4	5	6
Point Value	2	2	2	2	2	6

9. Victory Points

Victory Points (VP) are the primary mark of success for a captain. They are gained in the following methods:

1. Attacking an enemy ship and hitting their Shields with a **Volley** (1 VP).
2. Destroying at least one ship component with a **Volley** (1 VP).
3. Getting the kill shot on an enemy ship (3 VP instead of 1 from the **Volley**).
4. Breaching a Bauble on the round it is open (Varies per Bauble).

10. Card Listing

Base Orders Decks

	Face A		Face B	
#	Text 1	Text 2	Text 1	Text 2
2	Targeted Attack Aim +1	-	-	-
1	Targeted Attack Aim +2	-	-	-
3	Move 1		Turn Right, Move 1	Turn Left, Move 1
4	Move 2		Turn Right, Move 2	Turn Left, Move 2

Desperation Deck

When your ship starts to fall apart, you are at your best! Desperation cards represent the ingenuity of the captain and his crew in the heat of battle. Each Desperation card has a low power reusable Basic face and a high power single-use Desperate face.

When used on their single-use side (indicated by an underlined title) they are returned to the Desperation deck. When used on their low power side, they move to your Discard (or Overheat) pile as normal.

Desperation cards' Desperate face is not copied by Overdrive.

Most Desperation cards have a Basic face and a Desperate face, and are Hybrid - on that face, they are a Move in one orientation and an Attack in the other.

1. Move 2 / Attack Aim +2

There are several Desperation cards without a Basic face. Use in any fashion, they always return to the Desperation deck.

2. Crack Shot: Targeted Attack Damage +1
3. Afterburners: Move 3 / Turn Left Twice then Move 3, Turn Right Twice then Move 3

41	Face A		Face B	
Quantity	Text 1	Text 2	Text 1	Text 2
5	<u>Afterburners Move 3</u>	-	Afterburners Turn Right, Move 3	Afterburners Turn Left, Move 3
5	<u>Crack Shot Targeted Attack Damage +1</u>	-	-	-
3	Move 2	Attack Aim +2	<u>Reconfigure 2</u>	-
3	Move 2	Attack Aim +2	<u>Hull Repair 1</u>	-
3	Move 2	Attack Aim +2	<u>Steady Shot Aim +2 Damage +1</u>	-
3	Move 2	Attack Aim +2	<u>Side Slip Move 4 Right</u>	<u>Side Slip Move 4 Left</u>
3	Move 2	Attack Aim +2	<u>Drift King Move 4 turn Right 2</u>	<u>Drift King Move 4 turn Right 2</u>
3	Move 2	Attack Aim +2	<u>Thrust Ions Move 5</u>	-
3	Move 2	Attack Aim +2	<u>Crazy Ivan U-Turn Move 3</u>	<u>Crazy Ivan U-Turn Attack Aim +3</u>
3	Move 2	Attack Aim +2	<u>Active Cooling Move 1, Put Overheat Pile into Discard Pile</u>	-
1	Move 3	Attack Aim +3	<u>Turbo Ions Move 10</u>	-

1	Move 4	Attack Aim +4	<u>NightJammer Warp behind VP Leader</u> <u>Defense +5</u>	-
1	Move 5	Attack Aim +5	<u>Holdo Maneuver Move 3, Collide 3</u> <u>damage all</u>	-
1	Move 6	Attack Aim +6	<u>StarShot Attack Aim +999</u>	-
1	Move 7	Attack Aim +7	<u>ScatterShot Target all in 120 deg Cone</u>	-
1	Move 8	Attack Aim +8	<u>Lead the Target Attack Ignores Moves.</u> <u>Damage +1</u>	-
1	Move 2	Attack Aim +2	Overdrive 2x	-

11. Expansions

Expansions add complexity to the game and are recommended for experienced players only:

1. StarCommand: Adds Pilots/Ships and Starfall events. These modify each player's basic abilities and generate random effects at the start of each round.
2. StarTech: Adds Engineering cards, a 3rd type. Engineering cards often have ongoing effects that aren't directly moving or damage.
3. StarBreach: Adds NPC ships and bosses.

StarCommand

The “StarCommand” expansion adds unique Sunjammer Captains and random Starfall system-wide events.

Sunjammer Captains

At the beginning of the game, each player chooses a Captain, which modifies their ship’s operation. Randomly assign the ships, or allow players to choose their favorite. These are printed in 4 cards, with a/b on card 1, c/d on card 2, etc.

Captain List

- a. Malcolm “Sarge” Manderly: Malcolm has +2 to all Attack Rolls
- b. Anya “Fura” Andrews: Anya has one additional action that can’t be Overdriven, but has no Shields
- c. Riley “Turbo” Rounder: Riley has +1 Move from Move cards, but no bonus defense from movement
- d. Danny “Drifter” Davos: Danny moves 2 tiles forward at the beginning of the Cleanup step
- e. Carlos “Danger” Connor: Carlos gains 1 VP whenever he loses a ship component
- f. Knute “Rocky” Knuckle: Knute’s Bridge and Life Support components take 2 hits to destroy.
- g. Beto “Golden” Briego: Beto gains 1 additional VP and 1 additional Desperation card from Baubles
- h. Illyria “Boney” Landow: When the first Starfall event of the round is revealed, if Illyria’s Bone Room is intact she chooses to either gain 1 VP or place the Starfall event on the bottom of the Starfall deck so the next event happens instead.

Starfall Events

Solar storms and cosmic disasters plague the vast expanses of space, causing unpredictable mayhem for all crews alike. After drawing for the turn but before issuing orders, reveal a new Starfall card. Its effect applies immediately to all players and persists through the end of this round’s Cleanup step.

When a Starfall event deals damage, no cards are Overheated nor Desperation cards drawn (except by Captain abilities). Shields may absorb the damage unless specified otherwise.

Starfall Deck

1. Solar Storm: Roll a single damage die. It applies to all players and penetrates shields.
2. Gravity Burst: Move all ships 2 tiles towards The Fang (the center Bauble).
3. Clear Skies: All ships roll 3d6 for attacks instead of 2d6 this round.
4. Stars Align: Roll a d6, rerolling 6’s. The matching round’s Baubles open this round.
5. Take Cover: At the end of this round, deal 2 damage to all players outside of a Bauble’s range. Any Bauble provides protection, even if it is not open.
6. Golden Bounty: This turn, when you hit an enemy ship for the first time during an Action (including hitting Shields), gain 1 additional VP.
7. Most Dangerous Game: All Baubles open this round, but only yield 2 VP.
8. Sudden Chill: Each player shuffles their Overheat pile into their deck, then draws a card.
9. TBD
10. TBD
11. TBD
12. TBD

StarTech

Adds new Engineering Action type cards with static effects

StarBreach

Players cannot attack each other, instead targeted attacks always attack an enemy ship. There will be up to 4 enemy ship pairs in play, two of each color. Boss is targeted by putting your targeting attack sideways to the rest of the stack as a 5th mode.

Having a large boss ship and multiple smaller ships that deal damage but can quickly be eliminated.

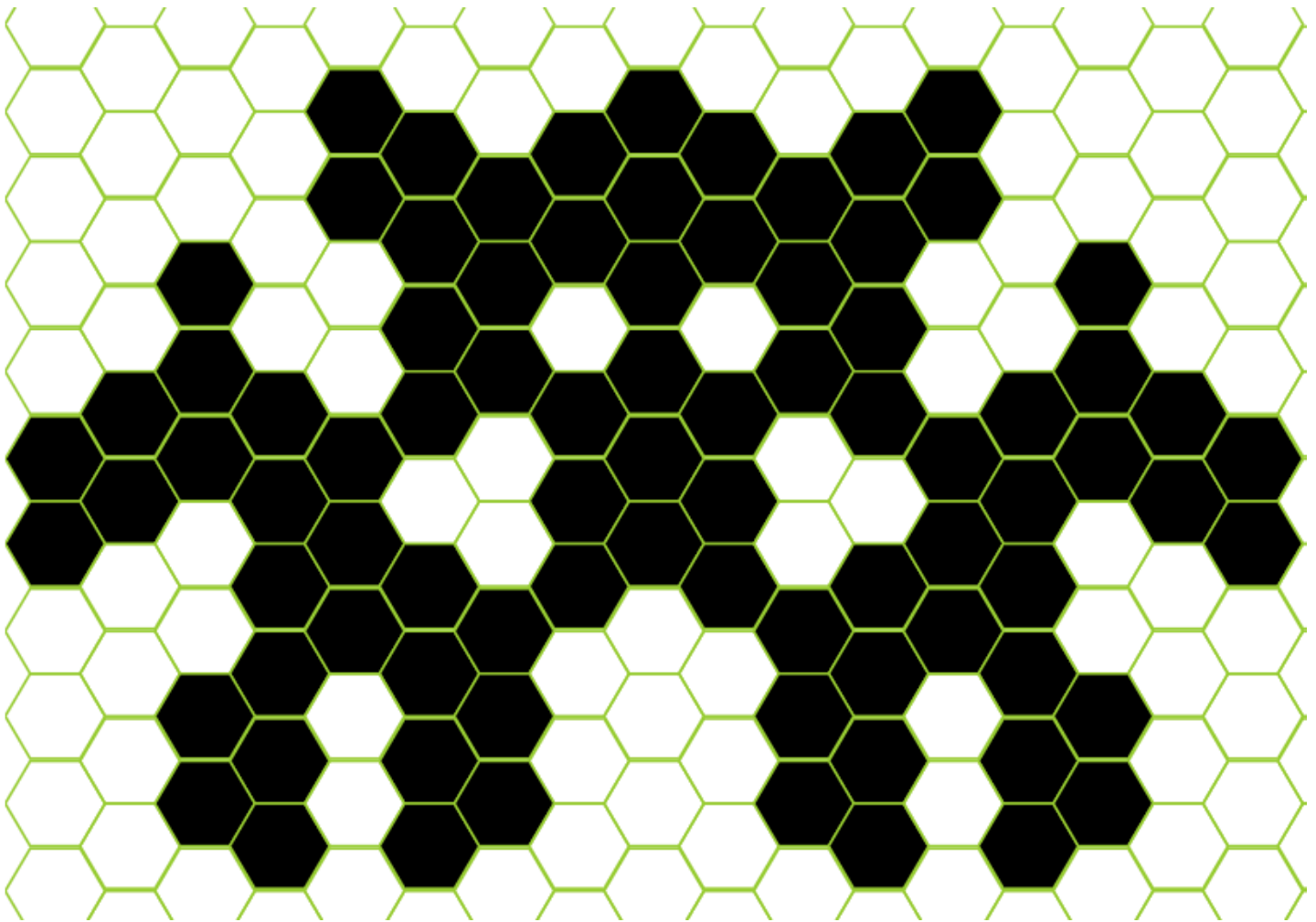
Roll a d6 for the damage lane, one from each axis through the center.

Capital ships special damage rule

When you roll a Bonus Damage roll or Overdrive and hit twice, both your shots come down a single lane, allowing you to “punch” deeper into the ship.

When you roll for a damage lane, you can shift the impact point by up to your +Aim bonus on that attack.

Capital ships



Capital ships have several key areas that give them functionality

1. Area shields: independent shields that cover just one part of the ship. Supported by Shield Generators throughout the ship, and killing the relevant generator takes the shields offline w/out penetrating them first.
2. Engine Bays: removing part of an Engine module eliminates a movement card the ship would normally draw and use
3. Ion Cannon Bays: support the use of extra attack cards

Scenarios:

- Destroy The Fang: The Prey must be in the Fang at the end of turn 6.
- Survival of the fittest: One player must survive
- Bauble Reapers: 8/10 Baubles must be harvested, plus The Fang
- ???

Enemy ships do not care about facing for movement, and they don't "overshoot" if they reach their target. Enemy ships move after player ships in the Action step, and shoot after the players in the Action step. They shoot in spawn order

They can mix attacks and moves, don't overdrive (except boss?)

They always draw 5 cards (non-boss)

Ships draw 2+1 cards per player (bosses higher)

They play fill their early actions before later actions (ie with 5 cards, they play 1/1, 2/2, 3)

Idea: Enemy ships have steps in between the player steps:

- Step 1.5 and step 2.5
- Boss ship gets a step 3.5
- Enemies stack their cards across their 2 (or 3) steps evenly loading the first step highest.
- This reduces their number of actions and makes play faster, as well as not interleaving with players
- One stack for each enemy type

Bosses have an Upgrade track and a Phase Change card to force. ie.

1: [][][] 2: [][][] 3: [][][]

So each upgrade pushes them to higher power, and when they hit a phase change card, they jump ahead immediately.

Maybe boss cards are the back side sometimes on normal cards?

They have an NPC deck which contains standard cards and boss cards:

- Standard cards
 - Movement (non-directed) in small, medium, or large amounts
 - Shooting (some +aim, some +damage)
 - Upgrade: Ships draw one more card (or boss advancement track moves up)
 - Maybe hybrid cards that are interpreted differently for different ship types
- Boss cards
 - Mixed into the normal Enemy deck
 - When drawn, go into the boss's action stack or ignored if before/after boss
 - Shooting Stars: 1 damage to all other ship
 - Restore shields (Bridge->Cannons->Engines->Shields)
 -

When a player attacks, they declare a component of the ship they are targeting:

- Shield Generators (multiple clustered components that power other area's shields)
- Cannons
- Engines
- Bridge

If they hit the enemy, they roll just against that sub-area

Consider having a large “boss” ship that is more than one hex in size.
Award VP/Cards for hitting critical systems on the enemies

“Good Stuff for Enemies”

- Gain cards similar to players?
- Advance some kind of track? Maybe the Boss Goals track?
- Gain enemy VP?

Bauble Chaser

This lightweight ship runs the bauble routes, scoring bonus points for the Void Breachers.

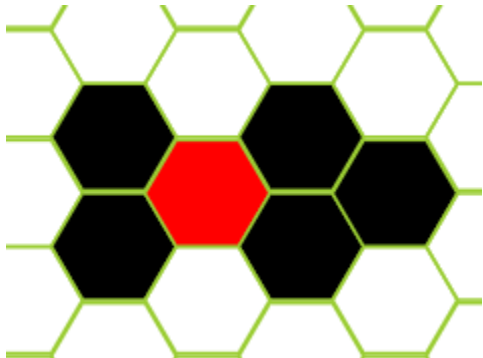
- Start at The Fang at the beginning of Round 1
- Moves towards the center of this round’s Bauble with its moves.
 - Except initially the two go to opposite Bauble #1’s.
 - Doesn’t overshoot Baubles if it arrives
- Has +1 to movement cards
- Fires at nearest player ship
- When it scores a Bauble <Good stuff for enemies>



Hunter-Killer

This mid-weight ship has a player to destroy and hunts relentlessly

- At game start, designate 1 player as the Prey
- Starts at a random Bauble (roll d6) at the beginning of Round 2
- Moves towards the Prey with all its moves, doesn’t overshoot
- Always attacks The Prey
- Has +1 to Aim
- When it hits The Prey <Good stuff for enemies>



Blaster

This heavy-weight ship blasts and wrecks

- Starts at a random Bauble (roll d6) at the beginning of Round 4
- Moves towards the nearest player ship (roll to break ties), doesn't overshoot
- Attacks the nearest player with all its attacks
- Has +1 to damage
- When it hits a player <Good stuff or enemies>



Boss Ship

This capital class ship has a mission to complete, supported by its swarms of allies

- Spawns at The Fang at the beginning of Round 3
- Takes up 3 tiles on the space board, but has a “nose” tile from which it tracks attacks and movement, although itself can be damaged on any tile.

Map Shape



-
- Has +1 Aim, Moves, and Damage
- Multiple ship designs, each created with a specific purpose and goal/track
- Has multiple areas players can target, each with its own set of d6 damage lanes
 - When players hit an area, they can adjust their damage lane by up to their Aim bonus on that attack
- Proposed Player Missions
 - Destroy The Fang: The Prey must be in the Fang at the end of turn 6.
 - Boss behaves like a Hunter-Killer, including bonuses for hitting the Prey
 - Bauble Reapers: 8/10 Baubles must be harvested, plus The Fang
 - Boss behaves like a Bauble Chaser, including bonuses for getting Baubles
 - Kill the Boss: Finish off the boss before the end of Round 6
 - Boss behaves like a Blaster
 - Hotshots: Get more VP than the NPCs
 - NPC's get VP for hitting players and Baubles
 - Boss moves towards and shoots at the most damaged player besides the Prey, roll a dice in case of a tie

Boss cards

Played in action slot 3.5 (as you draw for the boss, place them there, until it is full, then place non-boss sides)

- Ramming attack

- Spreadshot (cone attack)
- Seeker Missiles (+10 to hit)
- Knockback double-shot
- Engine flare (spread damage behind)
-

StarTrader

Adds starbases and system upgrades. Players have secret mission goals that reward bonus VP at end game, and subgoals after turns 2 and 4 that yield bonuses.